

Word family: **spend / spends / spent / spending / spender / expenditure / expensive?**

Base word: spend

Third-person singular: spends

Past tense: spent

Past participle: spent

** -ing form:** spending

Related forms: spending, spender

Useful constructions/extensions: spend time, spend money, spend + time + doing, spend + money + on, spend time with someone, spend energy/resources, spending, consumer spending, government spending, big spender, spent = used up/exhausted

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective-like forms (相關名詞及形容詞式用法)

Your passage contains:

> “My supervisor asked me to represent the team and present a project I had **spent months working on**.”

Here, **spend** refers to **using a period of time on an activity**.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> “I had **spent months working on** the project”

spend means:

to use a period of time doing a particular activity.

You used several months of your time:

* working on the project;

* developing it;

* preparing it;

* contributing to its progress.

Meaning: To use a period of time doing or experiencing something.

繁體中文: **把一段時間用在某項活動、工作或經歷上**

中文翻譯:

> “My supervisor asked me to represent the team and present a project I had spent months working on.”

「我的上司叫我代表團隊, 介紹一個我已經**花了幾個月時間進行／參與的項目**。」

So:

spend months working on something = 花幾個月時間做／推進某件事

1. **spend + time + doing something (花時間做某事) — 花.....時間做.....**

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To use a period of time doing a particular activity.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I had **spent months working on** the project.”

「我已經**花了幾個月時間做／推進**這個項目。」

Practice 2

> “She **spent two hours preparing** her slides.”

「她**花了兩個小時準備**投影片。」

Practice 3

> “We **spent the afternoon discussing** the proposal.”

「我們**花了整個下午討論**這項提案。」

spend + time + doing = 把一段時間投入某項活動

Common:

* spend an hour reading

* spend all day working

* spend months preparing

* spend years studying

2. **spend + time + on + noun (把時間花在.....) — 花時間在.....上**

A closely related grammatical pattern.

Practice 4

> “I **spent a lot of time on** the presentation.”

「我**花了很多時間在**這次簡報上。」

Practice 5

> “She **spent three weeks on** the report.”

「她**花了三個星期處理**這份報告。」

spend time on something = 把時間投入某項工作、活動或事物

Compare:

> **spend two hours preparing**

and:

> **spend two hours on preparation**

Same broad meaning, different grammar.

3. **spend time with someone (與某人共度時間) — 跟某人一起過時間**

A very common everyday use.

Practice 6

> “I like to **spend time with** my family.”

「我喜歡**跟家人一起共度時間**。」

Practice 7

> “She **spent the weekend with** her friends.”

「她**和朋友一起度過了週末**。」

spend time with someone = 跟某人在一起度過一段時間

This is not merely “use time on a task”; the emphasis is companionship.

4. **spend + period + somewhere (在某地度過一段時間) — 在.....度過**

Practice 8

> “We **spent three days in London**.”

「我們**在倫敦度過了三天**。」

Practice 9

> “She **spent the summer abroad**.”

「她**在海外度過了夏天**。」

spend + period + place = 在某個地方度過一段時間

5. **spend + period + as/in role (以某身份度過一段時間) — 擔任／處於某身份一段時間**

Practice 10

> “He **spent five years as a manager**.”

「他**當了五年經理**。」

Practice 11

> “She **spent most of her career in finance**.”

「她職業生涯的大部分時間都**在金融業度過**。」

spend + period + in/as = 在某個身份、職業或環境中度過一段時間

6. ****spend money(花錢) — 花費; 支出****

This is the other major core meaning.

****Meaning:**** To use money to buy something or pay for something.

Practice 12

> “I ****spent too much money**** on new equipment.”

「我在新設備上****花了太多錢****。」

Practice 13

> “The company ****spent millions**** on the new system.”

「公司在新系統上****花了數百萬元****。」

****spend money = 用金錢購買、支付或投資在某物／活動上****

7. ****spend + money + on + noun(在.....上花錢) — 花錢在.....****

Practice 14

> “She ****spent \$500 on**** a new laptop.”

「她****花了五百元買****一部新手提電腦。」

Practice 15

> “The business ****spent heavily on**** advertising.”

「這家公司在廣告方面****投入了大量資金****。」

****spend money on something = 把金錢用在購買、服務、活動或投資上****

8. ****spend + money + doing something(花錢做.....) — 花費金錢做某事****

Less common than ****spend money on****, but possible.

Practice 16

> “They **spent thousands renovating** the office.”

「他們**花了數千元翻新**辦公室。」

Practice 17

> “The company **spent a lot developing** the product.”

「公司**花了大量資金開發**這個產品。」

spend money doing something = 為完成某項活動而支出金錢

9. **spend on yourself/someone** (為自己／某人花錢) — 為……花費

Practice 18

> “She rarely **spends money on herself**.”

「她很少**花錢在自己身上**。」

Practice 19

> “Parents often **spend a lot on** their children.”

「父母往往會**在子女身上花很多錢**。」

spend on someone = 為某人的需要、享受或利益支付金錢

10. **spend energy/effort** (耗費精力／心力) — 花費; 耗用

A figurative extension from time/money.

Practice 20

> “I **spent a lot of energy** worrying before the presentation.”

「簡報前我因為擔心而**耗費了很多精力**。」

Practice 21

> “Don’t **spend all your energy** on small details.”

「不要把所有精力都**耗在小細節上**。」

spend energy/effort = 把有限的精力、心力或努力投入某件事

11. **spend resources** (耗用資源) — 使用; 耗費

Practice 22

> “The project **spent more resources** than expected.”

「這個項目**耗用了比預期更多的資源**。」

Practice 23

> “We should avoid **spending resources** on unnecessary work.”

「我們應避免在不必要的工作上**耗用資源**。」

spend resources = 把有限資源投入或消耗在某項活動上

This is more formal/business-like.

12. **spend time/money wisely** (善用) — 明智地花/使用

Practice 24

> “Try to **spend your time wisely**.”

「要嘗試**善用時間**。」

Practice 25

> “The company needs to **spend its budget wisely**.”

「公司需要**明智地使用預算**。」

****spend wisely = 有效、合理地分配時間／金錢／資源****

13. ****spend freely(大方花費) — 大手花錢****

Practice 26

> “Tourists were ****spending freely**** in the city.”

「遊客在城內****大手花錢****。」

Practice 27

> “People tend to ****spend more freely**** during holidays.”

「人們在假期期間往往會****較大方花錢****。」

****spend freely = 不太限制地花錢, 支出較多****

14. ****spend heavily(大量支出) — 大量花費****

Common in business/reporting.

Practice 28

> “The company ****spent heavily on**** research.”

「公司在研究方面****投入了大量資金****。」

Practice 29

> “The government is ****spending heavily on**** infrastructure.”

「政府正在基建方面****大量投放資金****。」

****spend heavily on = 在某個領域投入非常多金錢****

15. ****spend = use up over time(消耗) — 消耗; 耗去****

A broader literary/formal sense.

Practice 30

> “The long journey ****spent**** much of his strength.”

「漫長旅程****耗去**了他大量體力******。」

Practice 31

> “Years of stress had ****spent**** his energy.”

「多年的壓力****耗盡**了他的精力******。」

This bare transitive use is less common in everyday modern English than:

> expend

or:

> use up

So it should be treated as lower priority.

16. ****spending** = act/amount of spending money(支出) — 開支; 消費******

A major related noun.

Practice 32

> “The company reduced its ****spending****.”

「公司減少了****開支****。」

Practice 33

> “Household ****spending**** increased last month.”

「家庭****消費開支****上個月有所增加。」

****spending** = 花費金錢的行為, 或某段時間內花出的金額******

17. **consumer spending**(消費者支出) — 消費開支

A common economics term.

Practice 34

> “Consumer **spending** rose during the holiday season.”

「假期期間**消費者支出**上升。」

Practice 35

> “Weak consumer **spending** can slow economic growth.”

「疲弱的**消費開支**可能拖慢經濟增長。」

consumer spending = 消費者購買商品和服務所支出的金錢

18. **government/public spending**(政府／公共開支) — 政府支出; 公共開支

Practice 36

> “Government **spending** on healthcare increased.”

「政府在醫療方面的**支出**增加了。」

Practice 37

> “The debate focused on public **spending**.”

「辯論集中討論**公共開支**。」

government/public spending = 政府或公共部門為服務、政策和項目支付的資金

19. **spending cuts**(削減開支) — 開支削減

Practice 38

> “The department announced major **spending cuts**.”

「部門宣布大幅**削減開支**。」

Practice 39

> “The company introduced **spending cuts** to reduce costs.”

「公司為降低成本而實施**削減支出措施**。」

spending cuts = 減少原本預計／實際會花出的金錢

20. **spending limit** (消費／支出上限) — 支出上限

Practice 40

> “The card has a daily **spending limit**.”

「這張卡有每日**消費上限**。」

Practice 41

> “The project has a strict **spending limit**.”

「這個項目有嚴格的**支出上限**。」

spending limit = 某段時間／活動中最多可以花費的金額

21. **spender** = person/organization that spends money (花錢者) — 消費者; 花錢的人

A useful related noun.

Practice 42

> “He is a careful **spender**.”

「他是一個**花錢很謹慎的人**。」

Practice 43

> “Young consumers are becoming bigger ****spenders**** online.”

「年輕消費者在網上的****消費額愈來愈高****。」

****spender** = 以某種方式／程度花錢的人或機構******

22. ****big spender** (花錢很多的人) — 大手筆消費者******

Practice 44

> “The hotel offers special benefits to ****big spenders****.”

「酒店為****高消費顧客****提供特別優惠。」

Practice 45

> “He has never been a ****big spender****.”

「他從來都不是一個****大手花錢的人****。」

****big spender** = 經常或一次性花很多錢的人／顧客******

23. ****spent** = used up / exhausted (用盡的) — 耗盡的; 已用完的******

A genuinely distinct participial/adjective use.

Practice 46

> “The fuel was completely ****spent****.”

「燃料已經完全****耗盡****。」

Practice 47

> “The battery was nearly ****spent****.”

「電池電量幾乎****耗盡****。」

****spent** = 某種能源、資源或力量已經被使用到接近／完全耗盡******

This usage is more formal or technical than everyday ****used up****.

24. ****spent = extremely tired / exhausted (筋疲力盡的) — 精疲力盡的****

A useful figurative adjective sense.

Practice 48

> “After the presentation, I felt completely ****spent****.”

「簡報結束後，我感到****筋疲力盡****。」

Practice 49

> “She collapsed into a chair, emotionally ****spent****.”

「她情緒上已經****精疲力竭****，一下子坐到椅子上。」

****spent = 身體、精神或情緒上的能量幾乎完全耗盡****

This is closely related to ****exhausted****.

25. ****spent force (失去力量／影響力的事物) — 已失去作用的力量****

A fixed expression.

Practice 50

> “The movement had become a ****spent force****.”

「這場運動已經成為一股****失去影響力的力量****。」

Practice 51

> “By then, the argument was largely a ****spent force****.”

「到了那時，那個論點已經基本上****失去影響力****。」

****a spent force = 曾經有力量／影響，但現在已經耗盡作用的事物或勢力****

26. **spend the night(過夜) — 過夜; 住一晚**

A very common time construction.

Practice 52

> “We **spent the night** at a hotel.”

「我們在酒店**住了一晚／過夜**。」

Practice 53

> “She had to **spend the night** at the airport.”

「她不得不在機場**過夜**。」

spend the night = 在某個地方度過整個晚上／夜間

27. **spend the day/weekend/holiday(度過) — 度過一天／週末／假期**

Practice 54

> “I **spent the weekend** preparing for the presentation.”

「我**整個週末都在準備**簡報。」

Practice 55

> “They **spent the holiday** with family.”

「他們**和家人一起度過假期**。」

spend + period = 以某種方式、在某個地方或跟某人一起度過一段時間

28. **spend your life/career doing something(人生／職業生涯投入於……) — 一生／職業生涯都在……**

Practice 56

> “He **spent his career working** in education.”

「他的整個職業生涯都**投身教育工作**。」

Practice 57

> “She **spent her life helping** others.”

「她**一生都在幫助別人**。」

spend your life/career doing something = 把人生／職業生涯中的很長時間投入某件事

Important distinction: **spend time vs take time**

This is crucial.

spend time

focuses on the person using their time:

> “I **spent two hours preparing**.”

「我**花了兩個小時準備**。」

take time

focuses on how long the activity requires:

> “The preparation **took two hours**.”

「準備工作**花了兩個小時**。」

Compare:

> **I spent two hours on it.**

subject = person using time

> **It took me two hours.**

subject = task requiring time

Important distinction: **spend vs cost**

spend

focuses on the buyer/person using money:

> “I **spent \$100** on the course.”

「我花了一百元。」

cost

focuses on the thing's price:

> “The course **cost \$100**.”

「課程費用是一百元。」

So:

person spends money

but:

thing costs money

Important distinction: **spend vs pay**

spend

= use money generally

> “I **spent \$200** on equipment.”

pay

= give money to a person/company or for a particular bill/service

> “I **paid the supplier \$200**.”

> “I paid \$200 for the equipment.”

So:

****spend = 花費****

****pay = 付款****

Important distinction: **spend money on vs pay for**

Compare:

> “I ****spent \$500 on**** the laptop.”

= 我在手提電腦上花了五百元。

> “I ****paid \$500 for**** the laptop.”

= 我為手提電腦支付了五百元。

Very similar result, but grammar differs.

Important distinction: **spend vs invest**

**spend**

is neutral:

> use money/time/resources.

**invest**

suggests:

> use money/time/resources now in expectation of future benefit.

Compare:

> “The company spent money on training.”

neutral statement

> “The company invested in training.”

suggests training is expected to produce future value.

Not all spending is investment.

Important distinction: ****spend time vs waste time****

****spend time****

is neutral:

> use time.

****waste time****

means:

> use time badly or without useful result.

> “I spent two hours practising.”

= neutral/positive.

> “I wasted two hours waiting for nothing.”

= negative.

So ****spend**** itself does not imply waste.

Important distinction: ****spend vs use****

****use****

is broader:

* use a tool;

* use information;

- * use time;
- * use resources.

spend

is especially natural with finite resources that are gradually consumed:

- * time;
- * money;
- * energy.

> “spend time”

> “spend money”

> “spend energy”

But:

> “use a computer”

not normally:

>  spend a computer

Important distinction: **spend + time doing vs spend + time on**

Both are standard.

Activity clause:

> “She spent three hours **practising**.”

Noun:

> “She spent three hours **on practice**.”

The first is usually more natural when describing the actual action.

Important distinction: **spent = past tense vs spent = exhausted**

Past tense:

> “I **spent** three hours preparing.”

= 我花了三小時準備。

Adjective-like:

> “Afterwards, I felt **spent**.”

= 之後我感到筋疲力盡。

Same spelling, completely different grammatical role and meaning.

Important distinction: **spent** vs **exhausted**

spent

often emphasizes:

> all energy has been used up.

It can be:

- * physical;
- * emotional;
- * mental.

exhausted

is much more common everyday English for extreme tiredness.

> “I was exhausted.”

is more neutral/common than:

> “I was spent.”

Spent can sound more literary or emphatic.

Important distinction: **spending vs expense**

spending

= the act/amount of spending money

> government spending

expense

= a cost/item of expenditure

> travel expenses

So:

spending = 支出行為／總額

expense = 某項費用／成本

Important distinction: **spending vs expenditure**

spending

is common everyday/business language.

expenditure

is more formal, especially in:

* finance;

* accounting;

* government reports.

> government expenditure

= 政府支出

For learners:

spending = 較日常

****expenditure = 較正式／財務用語****

Important distinction: **spend time with someone vs spend time on someone**

**spend time with someone**

= 跟某人一起相處

**spend time on someone**

can mean:

> devote time to helping, training, analysing, or dealing with that person

Compare:

> “I spent time ****with**** my colleague.”

= 我跟同事相處了一段時間。

> “The coach spent extra time ****on**** the new player.”

= 教練在這名新球員身上額外花了時間指導。

Preposition changes the relationship.

Family-extension sweep

The practical ****spend**** family is concentrated around using limited resources:

* ****spend time doing**** = 花時間做.....

* ****spend time on something**** = 把時間花在某事上

* ****spend time with someone**** = 跟某人共度時間

* ****spend time somewhere**** = 在某地度過時間

* ****spend years as/in**** = 以某身份／在某領域度過多年

* ****spend money**** = 花錢

* ****spend money on**** = 在.....上花錢

* ****spend money doing**** = 花錢做.....

* ****spend on someone**** = 為某人花錢

* **spend energy/effort** = 耗費精力／心力
 * **spend resources** = 耗用資源
 * **spend wisely** = 善用時間／金錢
 * **spend freely** = 大手花錢
 * **spend heavily on** = 大量投放資金
 * **spending** = 支出／消費
 * **consumer spending** = 消費者支出
 * **government spending** = 政府支出
 * **spending cuts** = 削減開支
 * **spending limit** = 支出上限
 * **spender** = 花錢的人／消費者
 * **big spender** = 高消費者／大手花錢的人
 * **spent — used up** = 已耗盡的
 * **spent — exhausted** = 筋疲力盡的
 * **spent force** = 已失去影響力的力量
 * **spend the night/day/weekend** = 度過夜晚／一天／週末
 * **spend your life/career doing** = 一生／職業生涯都投入於……

The main semantic branches are:

> **use time**

> **use money**

> **use energy/resources**

> **spending as financial expenditure**

> **spent = used up / exhausted**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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spend + time + doing	把一段時間投入某項活動; 花……時間做……
spend time on something	把時間投入某項工作、活動或事物
spend time with someone	跟某人在一起共度一段時間
spend + period + place	在某個地方度過一段時間
spend + period + as/in role	在某個身份、職業或環境中度过一段時間
spend money	使用金錢購買、支付或投資在某物／活動上
spend money on something	把金錢用在某項購買、服務、活動或投資上
spend money doing something	為進行／完成某項活動而支出金錢

spend on someone	為某人的需要、享受或利益支付金錢	
spend energy/effort	把有限的精力、心力或努力投入某件事	
spend resources	把有限資源投入／消耗於某項工作或活動	
spend wisely	合理而有效地分配時間、金錢或資源	
spend freely	不太限制地花錢；大手支出	
spend heavily on	在某個領域投入大量金錢	
spending — general	花費金錢的行為，或某段時間內支出的金額	
consumer spending	消費者購買商品和服務所支出的金錢	
government/public spending	政府／公共部門為政策、服務和項目支付的資金	
spending cuts	減少原本會花出的金錢；削減開支	
spending limit	某段時間或活動中最多可以花費的金額	
spender	以某種方式或程度花錢的人／機構	
big spender	經常或一次性花很多錢的高消費者	
spent — used up	某種能源、資源或力量已被使用到接近／完全耗盡	
spent — exhausted	身體、精神或情緒上的能量幾乎完全耗盡；筋疲力盡	
spent force	曾經有力量／影響，但現在已失去主要作用的勢力／事物	
spend the night/day/weekend	以某種方式、在某地或與某人一起度過指定時間	
spend your life/career doing	把人生／職業生涯中的長時間投入某項活動或工作	

For your original passage

> “My supervisor asked me to represent the team and present a project I had ****spent months working on****.”

The exact meaning is:

****spend = 把一段時間投入某項工作或活動****

Therefore:

> ****spend months working on a project****

= ****「花幾個月時間參與、處理和推進一個項目」****

The grammatical pattern is:

> ****spend + amount of time + -ing****

So:

> ****spent months working****

= ****花了幾個月時間工作／進行****

The sentence emphasizes that this was not a project you had only recently encountered. You had already invested a substantial amount of time in it.

So the key mapping in your passage is:

****spend time = 把時間投入某件事情****

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****spend three hours preparing****

> = 花三小時準備

> ****spend three hours on the presentation****

> = 在簡報上花三小時

> ****spend time with family****

> = 跟家人共度時間

> ****spend the weekend in London****

> = 在倫敦度過週末

> ****spend \$500 on equipment****

> = 在設備上花五百元

> ****spend energy worrying****

> = 因擔心而耗費精力

> ****consumer spending****

> = 消費者支出

> ****a big spender****

> = 花錢很多的人

> ****I felt spent****

> = 我感到筋疲力盡

That last contrast is especially useful because:

> ****spent months working****

uses ****spent**** as the ****past tense of spend****,

whereas:

> **I was completely spent**

uses **spent** adjectivally to mean:

「我已經精疲力盡。」